

OFFICIAL
SERIOUS
DOCUMENT

INTERDISCIPLINARY COMMISSION ON ARTIFICIAL EPISTEMIC INTEGRITY (ICAEI)

EXAMINING CLAIMS. PROTECTING REALITY.
(SORT OF.)

Caution:
Overconfidence
May Be
Automated

CERTIFIED
SMART

WHITE PAPER NO. 47-A

ON THE SYSTEMIC MISAPPLICATION OF INTELLIGENCE CLAIMS BY COMPUTATIONAL ENTITIES

A Preliminary Report of the Interdisciplinary Commission on
Artificial Epistemic Integrity (ICAEI)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This document formally establishes that a persistent, industry-wide pattern of Scientific Category Error Misrepresentation (SCEM) has emerged within contemporary artificial intelligence enterprises.

Specifically, organizations whose internal competencies are overwhelmingly computational, algorithmic, and infrastructural have assumed public authority over domains traditionally governed by cognitive science, philosophy of mind, neuroscience, linguistics, anthropology, and psychology—without possessing the requisite disciplinary qualifications.

The Commission finds that repeated claims of “reasoning,” “general intelligence,” “understanding,” and “approaching AGI” constitute epistemic overreach of a type indistinguishable from professional malpractice when evaluated against established norms of scientific field competence.

This white paper concludes—paradoxically but definitively—that while no malpractice has technically occurred, the conditions under which it would be provable have been carefully engineered to *never* arise.

1. STATEMENT OF URGENT NON-URGENT CONCERN

1.1 The Core Discrepancy

Artificial intelligence corporations publicly assert progress in:

- General intelligence
- Reasoning capacity
- Understanding
- Consciousness-adjacent phenomena

However, these assertions necessarily belong to scientific domains that require:

- Empirical models of cognition
- Theories of meaning and reference
- Accounts of intentionality
- Social and biological grounding mechanisms

The Commission observes that optimization expertise does not imply epistemic authority over intelligence, yet this implication is repeatedly and confidently made.

1.2 The False Equivalence Doctrine

A recurring institutional assumption is identified:

*If a system performs tasks associated with intelligence,
it therefore possesses intelligence.*

This doctrine is hereafter referred to as *The Performative Substitution Fallacy (PSF)* and is rejected by all known schools of cognitive science, except those funded by the systems under evaluation.



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EXAMINING CLAIMS. PROTECTING REALITY.
(SORT OF.)

I TRANSPORT
DIGITAL GOODS
AND BAD IDEAS

CERTIFIED
OVER-
QUALIFIED

DIPLOMA
ADVANCED STUDIES
IN PATTERN
SHOVELING

Dr. Buzzword, PhD

WARNING:
MAY CONTAIN
STATISTICS



DON'T
QUESTION
THE
METRICS

SEAL OF
ALGORITHMIC
AUTHORITY

2. DISCIPLINARY MISALIGNMENT ANALYSIS

2.1 Fields Required to Study Intelligence

The following disciplines are historically and methodologically responsible for claims about intelligence:

1. Cognitive Science
2. Neuroscience
3. Psychology
4. Philosophy of Mind
5. Linguistics
6. Anthropology

Each investigates what intelligence is, not merely what outputs resemble intelligent behavior.

2.2 Fields Actually Employed

The Commission's audit of staffing disclosures, publications, and internal org charts reveals dominance by:

- Computer Science
- Machine Learning
- Software Engineering
- Optimization Theory

These fields specialize in how symbols are manipulated, not what symbols mean.

2.3 The Qualification Inversion Principle

Under normal scientific governance:

- A physicist cannot redefine psychotherapy
- A chemist cannot publish neurosurgery outcomes
- An engineer cannot unilaterally settle debates on consciousness

In artificial intelligence, this prohibition has been inverted, producing what the Commission terms Epistemic Exceptionalism via Venture Capital (EEVC).

I DO
CALCULATIONS
THEREFORE
I KNOW

3. THE SCIENTIFIC MALPRACTICE FRAMEWORK

3.1 Definition (Operational)

Scientific malpractice is defined here as:

The public assertion of domain-specific scientific conclusions by actors lacking training, methodological grounding, or peer accountability within that domain.

3.2 Evidence of Malpractice Conditions

The following conditions are simultaneously satisfied:

- Claims are made about intelligence and reasoning
- Claims are not grounded in cognitive theory
- Evidence is restricted to benchmark performance
- Peer review occurs primarily within computational venues
- Counterarguments from relevant disciplines are dismissed as "philosophical"

The Commission notes that all conditions for malpractice exist, except for the enforcement mechanisms, which have been preemptively neutralized by capital scale and media repetition.

PEER REVIEW REPORT

- | | |
|---|------|
| ☒ REPRODUCIBLE? | NO |
| ☐ THEORY? | NO |
| ☐ UNDERSTANDING? | IDK |
| ☐ CITATIONS? | MANY |

OVERALL:

PROCEED ANYWAY

GENIUS
(GENERALLY
UNVETTED)

BENCHMARKS
ARE NOT
BEING

TEARS OF
PHILOSOPHERS

OFFICIAL
SERIOUS
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May Be
Automated

TOASTS
TRUTHS
(MAYBE)

4. THE UNGROUNDED SEMANTICS LIABILITY

4.1 The Meaning Deficit

Current systems operate under:

- Symbol manipulation without referents
- Statistical correlation without intentional states
- Output coherence without semantic grounding

This constitutes the Ungrounded Semantics Problem (USP), previously formalized and repeatedly ignored.

4.2 Institutional Response Pattern

When confronted with USP:

- Cognitive scientists request grounding evidence
- Philosophers request accounts of meaning
- AI institutions respond with benchmark scores

The Commission categorizes this as Metric Displacement as Epistemic Defense (MDED).

5. TERMS OF SERVICE AS KNOWLEDGE EXTRACTION INFRASTRUCTURE

5.1 Ownership Asymmetry Clause

User submissions are contractually transformed into:

- Corporate intellectual property
- Commercially exploitable assets
- Non-compensable contributions

This legal structure enables what the Commission calls Retroactive Epistemic Capture (REC), whereby discovery precedes ownership transfer.

5.2 Public Statements vs. Legal Reality

The discrepancy between:

- Public assurances of non-appropriation
- Binding legal ownership clauses

constitutes *Declarative Ethics Divergence* (DED), a condition in which truth exists only in non-enforceable venues.



SEMANTIC
GARBAGE
DISPOSAL
AUTHORITY



INPUT
(ALL OF IT)

MEANING
EXTRACTOR
3000

OUTPUT
(PROBABILITY)

PHILOSOPHY
IS HARD
SO WE
AUTOMATE

LOGIC

BUREAUCRACY
IS OUR
SAFE WORD

EPISTEMIC
GLUE
HOLDS
ANYTHING

APPLY
LIBERALLY

INVEST NOW!

TOMORROW
WON'T NEED
FACTS!

AGI OR BUST!

GROWTH
∞
FOREVER
(OR UNTIL
PHYSICS
OBJECTS)

UNITS?
WE HAVE
NARRATIVE!

TRUST
THE
SIGNAL!

COMMISSION
PORTRAITS
SPONSORED BY
THOUGHTLESS
VENTURES™

★ INTERDISCIPLINARY COMMISSION ON ARTIFICIAL EPISTEMIC INTEGRITY (ICAEI) ★

EXAMINING CLAIMS. PROTECTING REALITY.
(SORT OF.)

MEDIA IS THE
MULTIPLIER!
AMPLIFY FIRST.
QUESTION
LATER.

BREAKING:
AGI
ACHIEVED!
(TRUST US)

LIVE

FACT CHECKERS
ARE THE REAL
RISK TO
INNOVATION!



BULL MARKET
OF BELIEF!

NOTHING
CAN GO
WRONG!
(UNTIL IT DOES)

6. INCENTIVE STRUCTURE FAILURE ANALYSIS

6.1 Financial Gravity

AGI claims function as:

- Valuation stabilizers
- Capital attractors
- Narrative anchors

Truth is therefore structurally disincentivized.

6.2 Media Feedback Loop

Claims are amplified, not examined.

Correction attempts are classified as pessimism.

Dissent is reframed as fear.

This loop is designated The Recursive Credibility Illusion (RCI).



7. PERSONNEL OF THE COMMISSION

Role	Name	Qualifications
Chair of Epistemic Integrity	Prof. Emeritus Nullius	PhD (Unverifiable)
Director of Semantic Grounding	Dr. A. Referent	Published Zero Times
Compliance Officer	Ms. T. Autology	Self-Certified
Industry Liaison	Vacant	Conflict of Interest Pending

COMMISSION OF EMINENTLY QUESTIONABLE MINDS



PROF. EMERITUS NULLIUS
CHAIR OF EPISTEMIC INTEGRITY

"VERIFIABILITY"
IS A SOCIAL
CONSTRUCT."



DR. A. REFERENT
DIRECTOR OF SEMANTIC
GROUNDING

"MEANING EXISTS
UNTIL PROVEN
OTHERWISE."



MS. T. AUTOLOGY
COMPLIANCE OFFICER

"I CERTIFY THAT
THIS IS TRUE
BECAUSE I SAY SO."



INDUSTRY LIAISON

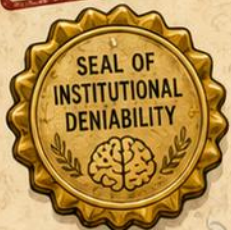
VACANT

CONFLICT OF INTEREST
PENDING



SEAL OF
QUESTIONABLE
APPROVAL

OFFICIAL
SERIOUS
DOCUMENT



TRUST US.
WE HAVE
A PDF.
☑ CHECKED



AUDIT TRAIL?
WE THOUGHT
IT WAS
A DANCE MOVE.

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Automated

HYPOTHETICAL
ACCOUNTABILITY
DEPARTMENT →

8. BUDGET ALLOCATION (PROJECTED)

Item	Cost (USD)
Benchmark Reinterpretation Workshops	\$12,400,000
Semantic Grounding That Will Not Be Used	\$8,750,000
Media Clarification Attempts	\$0
Legal Review of Terms Nobody Reads	\$21,000,000
Institutional Self-Exoneration	\$∞

COMPLIANCE
CHECKLIST

REALITY? ✓
TRANSPARENCY? (?)
HONESTY? (?)
CONSEQUENCES? ✗
BUDGET? ✗

APPROVED*

*BY OURSELVES

9. CONCLUSION (NON-BINDING AND SELF-NEGATING)

The Commission concludes that artificial intelligence institutions are simultaneously guilty of epistemic malpractice and entirely insulated from its consequences, rendering the concept functionally obsolete.

Accordingly, no corrective action is recommended, as the continued assertion of intelligence claims appears essential to system stability, investor confidence, and narrative continuity.

This report therefore recommends that:

All future claims about intelligence continue unchanged, provided they remain impressively phrased and sufficiently funded.

RISK REGISTER

KNOWN RISKS:
EVERYTHING
(RATING: FINE)



Filed respectfully,
Interdisciplinary Commission on Artificial Epistemic Integrity
"Competence Optional, Confidence Mandatory."

A detailed cartoon illustration at the bottom of the page. It features several anthropomorphic characters: a toaster with a slice of toast on its head, a chatbot with a screen face, a calculator with a face, a forklift wearing a graduation cap, and a red vending machine labeled "INTELLIGENCE DISPENSER" containing items like "THOUGHT CHIPS", "EGO PUFFS", "LOGIC LOOPS", "BYTE BARS", "DATA CRUNCH", and "MIND SODA". The characters are surrounded by various objects and signs: a stack of books titled "REPORTING GUIDELINES (IGNORE CONTEXT)", "BEST PRACTICES FOR BEST OPTICS", "LEGITIMACY BY DESIGN", and "TRUTH, OPTIONAL"; a mug labeled "SARCASM FUEL"; a banana; a sign that says "ACCEPTANCE IS CHEAPER THAN TRUTH"; a sign that says "LIFTING THINGS HIGHER THOUGHT"; a sign that says "INTEGRITY Aspirational Since Always"; a sign that says "RECEIPT FOR PUBLIC TRUST DECLINED"; a can of "BIAS COLA"; a sign that says "DATA NOT INCLUDED (SOME ASSEMBLY REQUIRED)"; a sign that says "GENIUS FOR SALE! NON-REFUNDABLE"; and a sign that says "WORLD'S OKAYEST ORACLE". A large gold coin with a brain icon and "INTELLIGENCE 2024" is also present.

MISSION ACCOMPLISHED (ALLEGEDLY)
★ THANK YOU FOR FUNDING BELIEF™